

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U12 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U14 (born in 2013 or after)
- U16 (born in 2011 or after)
- U18 (born in 2009 or after)

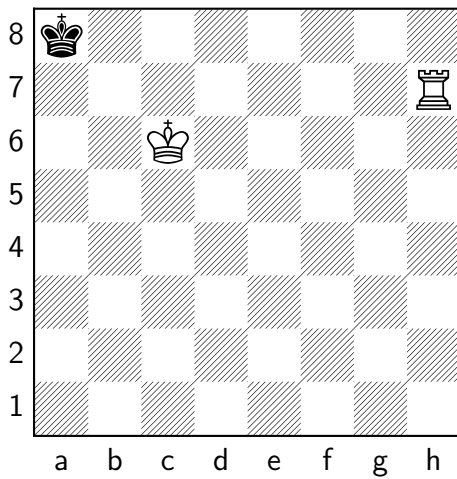
Please circle: Boy or Girl

Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You can leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions go from easy to hard, so it's best to start at the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and a point you can obtain. Please write your answers in the space under each picture. Altogether, the test has 100 points. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial points.
- For endgame puzzles, show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Example Q1. Mate in two.

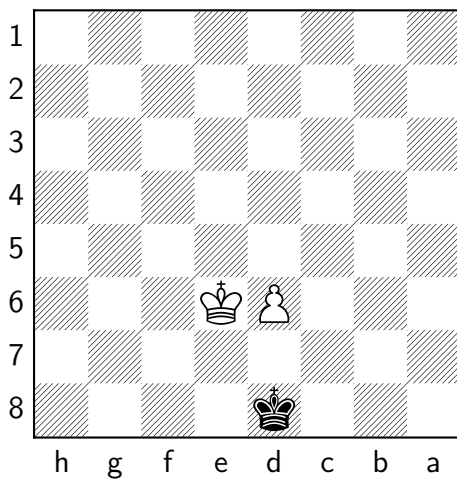


□ The open box shows White's move.

Answer:

1. Kb6 Kb8 ← Write the first White move, then the first Black move.
2. Rh8# (1-0) ← Write the second White move, which is a mate.

Example Q2. Black moves and draws.

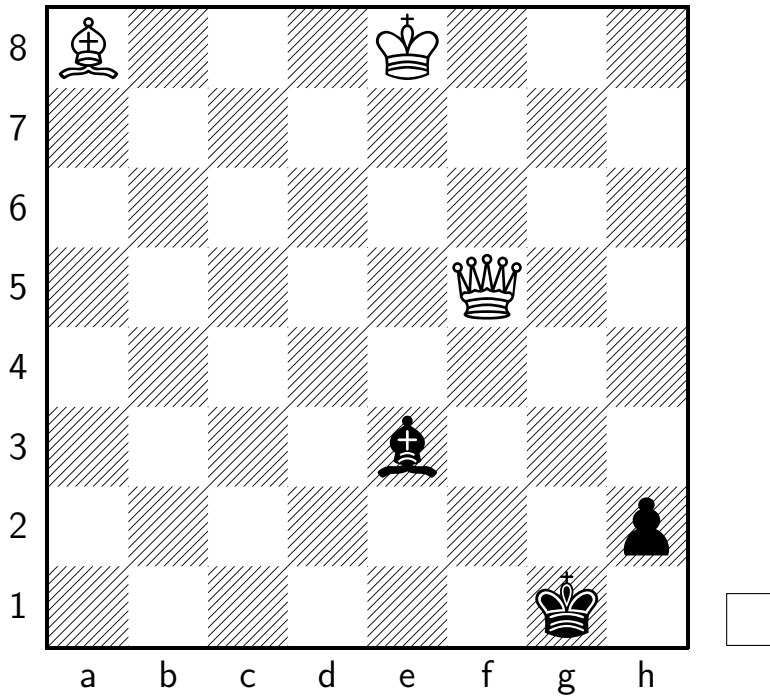


■ The closed box shows Black's move.

Answer:

1. ... Ke8
2. d7+ Kd8
3. Kd6 (draw) ← Write enough moves showing a clear draw position.

Q1. Mate in 3.



Answer:

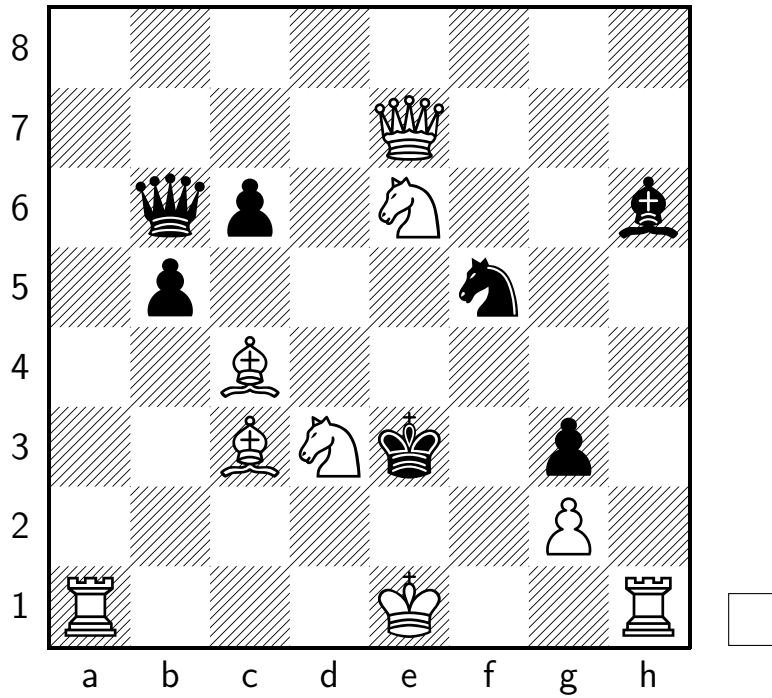
1 ♖h1 ♔×h1

2 ♕f1+ ♖g1

3 ♕f3#

Source: S.P Tsirulik 1956

Q2. Mate in 2.



Answer:

1 O-O-O (1 O-O fails as 1... bxc4)

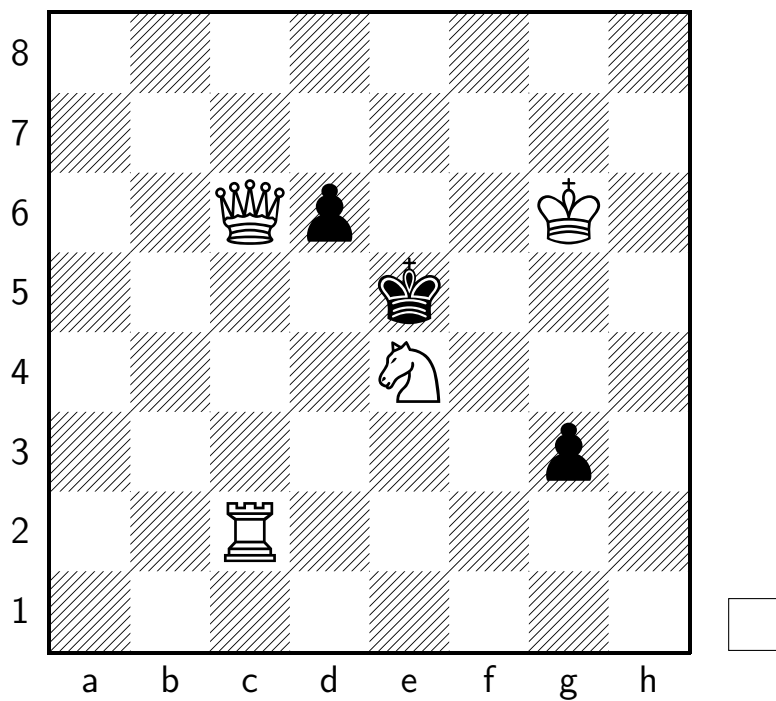
1... ♔e2+ 2 ♘ef4#

1... ♔e4+ 2 ♘g5#

1... ♘d4 2 ♘xd4#

Source: Michael Lipton, Great Britain - Israel, 1961 (YACPDB: 36663)

Q3. Mate in 2.



Answer:

1 ♞g5

1... ♔d4 2 ♚e4#

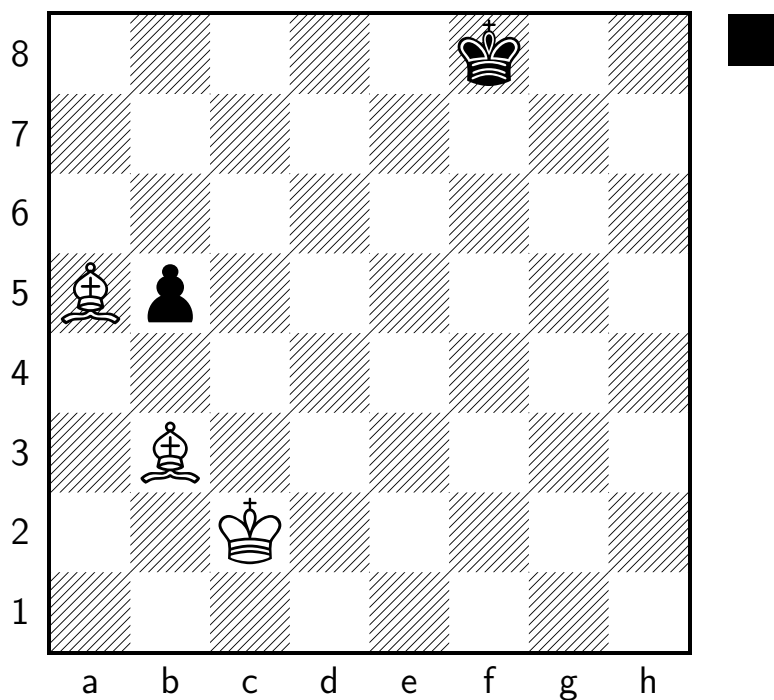
1... ♔f4 2 ♚e4#

1... g2 2 ♚e4#

1... d5 2 ♚f6#

Source: Gerhard Paul Latzel, Die Schwalbe, 1956 (YACPDB: 41896)

Q4. Helpmate in 5. Black to play first and help White to mate in 5 moves. (4 marks)



Answer:

0... ♔e7

1 ♘e1 ♕d6

2 ♕d2 ♕c5

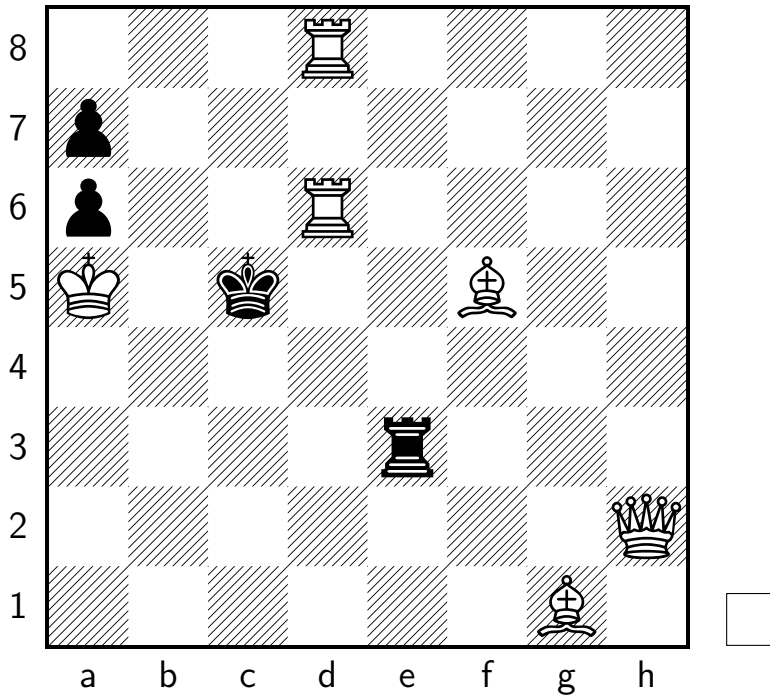
3 ♘d1 ♕b4

4 ♕c2+ ♕a4

5 ♕b2#

Source: Ebert Maslar, diagrammes, 1980 (YACPDB: 305488)

Q5. Selfmate in 5. White to play and force Black to mate White himself in 5 moves. (4 marks)



Answer:

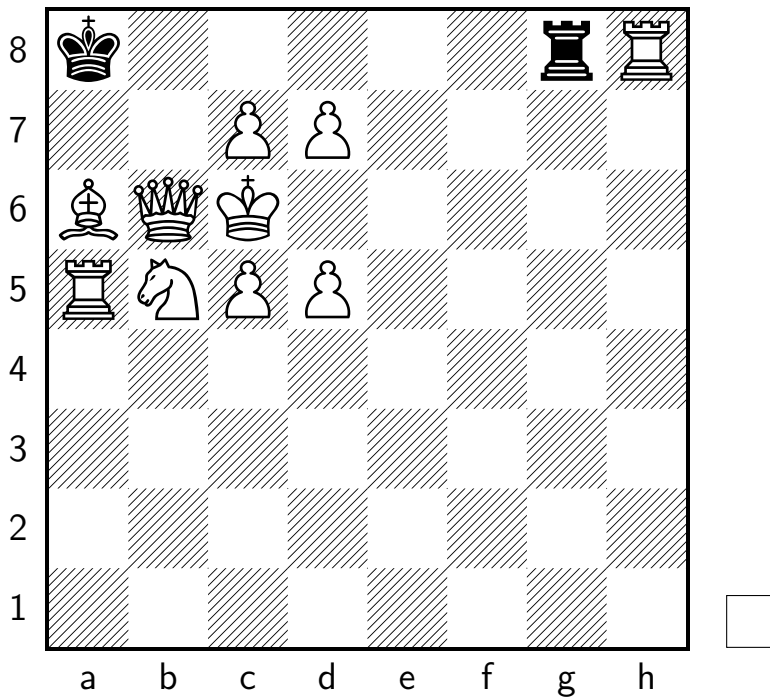
1 ♖d1 ♔c4
 2 ♕c2+ ♖c3
 3 ♕a2+ ♖b3
 4 ♙d3+ ♔c3
 5 ♕a3 ♖xa3#

or

1 ♖d1 ♔c6
 2 ♖c8+ ♔b7
 3 ♕h7+ ♖e7
 4 ♕h1+ ♖e4
 5 ♙b6 axb6#

Source: František Richter, Národní Osvození, 1935 (YACPDB: 261404)

Q6. Selfmate in 10. White to play and force Black to mate White himself in 10 moves. (4 marks)

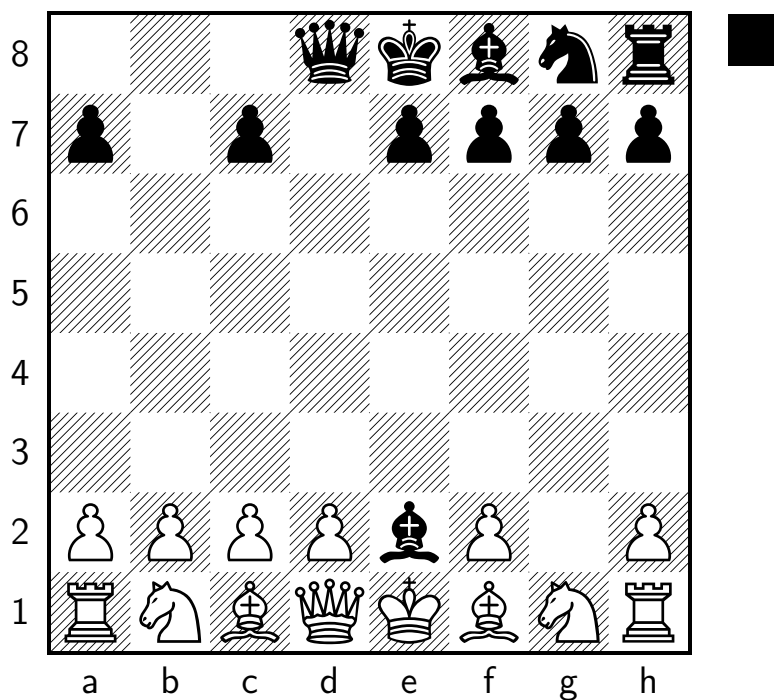


Answer:

- 1 ♖a7 ♜f8
- 2 ♜g8 ♜e8
- 3 ♜f8 ♜d8
- 4 ♜e8 ♜c8
- 5 ♜d8 ♜b8
- 6 ♜c8 ♜xc8
- 7 ♚b8+ ♜xb8
- 8 ♙b7+ ♜xb7
- 9 ♖b5+ ♜a7
- 5 ♜a6 ♜xa6#

Source: Edgar Dinwiddie Holladay, British Chess Magazine, 1965 (YACPDB: 303450)

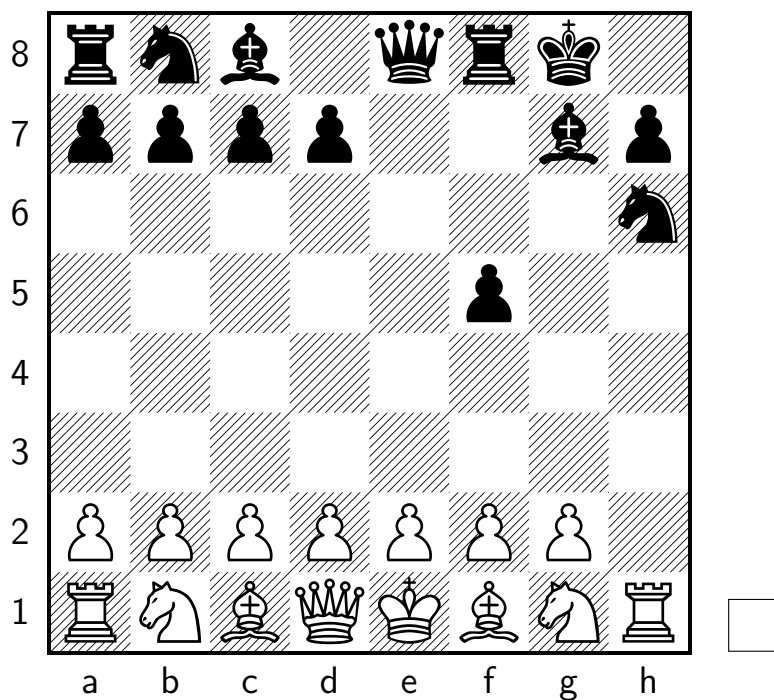
Q7. The position below occurred after the White's 7th move. Answer the moves to reach this position.



Answer:

- 1 e4 d5
- 2 exd5 ♘c6
- 3 dxc6 ♙h3
- 4 cxb7 ♙xg2
- 5 bxa8 ♙ ♙xf1
- 6 ♙g2 ♙e2
- 7 ♙f1

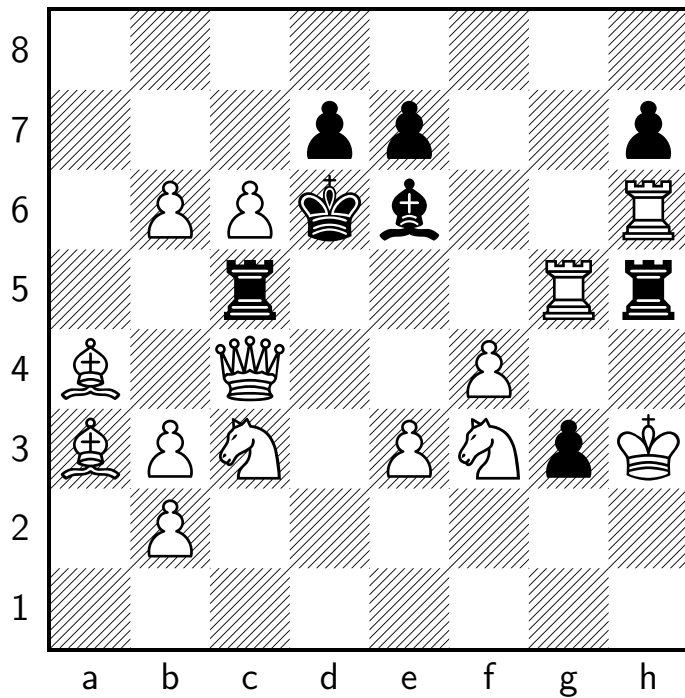
Q8. The position below occurred after the Black's 7th move. Answer the moves to reach this position.



Answer:

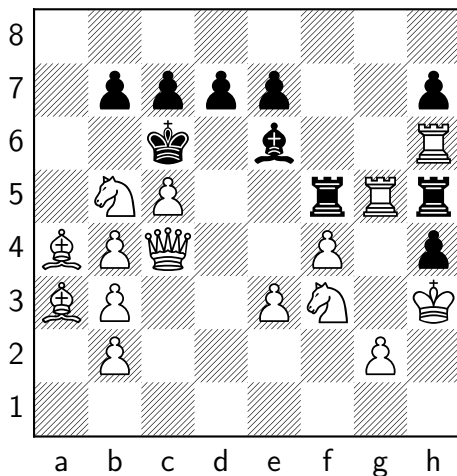
1 h4 f5
2 h5 ♔f7
3 h6 ♚e8
4 h×g7 ♖h6
5 g8♜ ♗g7
6 ♜×e7 ♚f8
7 ♜g8 ♔×g8

Q9. Answer the last 10 moves.



Answer:

- 1 h×g3+ g4 (Black - White)
- 2 ♖c5+ b×c6+
- 3 c5 b5+
- 4 ♔d6 c×b6+
- 5 b5 ♞c3+

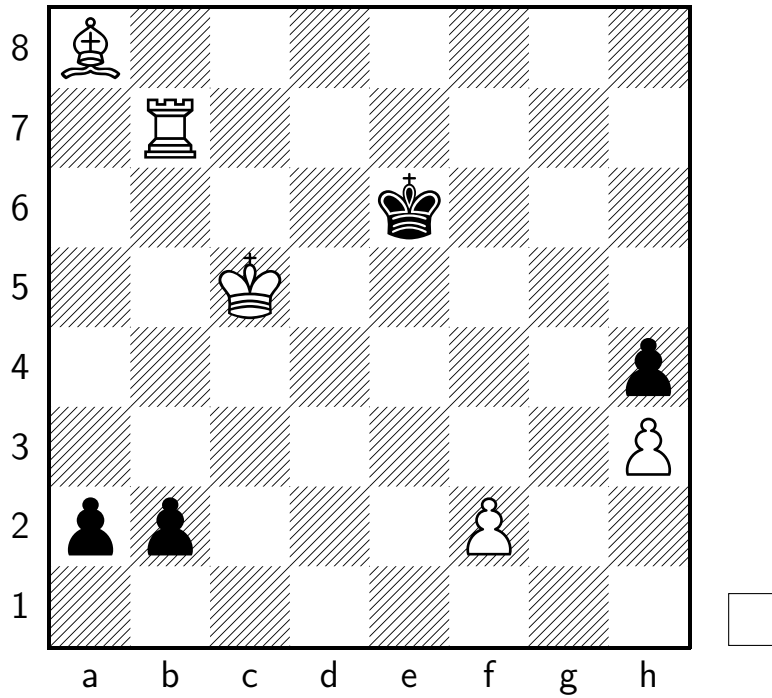


□ Followed by the moves below.

- 1 ♞c3+ b5 2 c×b6+ ♔d6 3 b5+ c5 4 b×c6+ ♖c5+ 5 g4 h×g3+

Source: H. Erikson, Stella Polaris, 1969

10. White play to win.

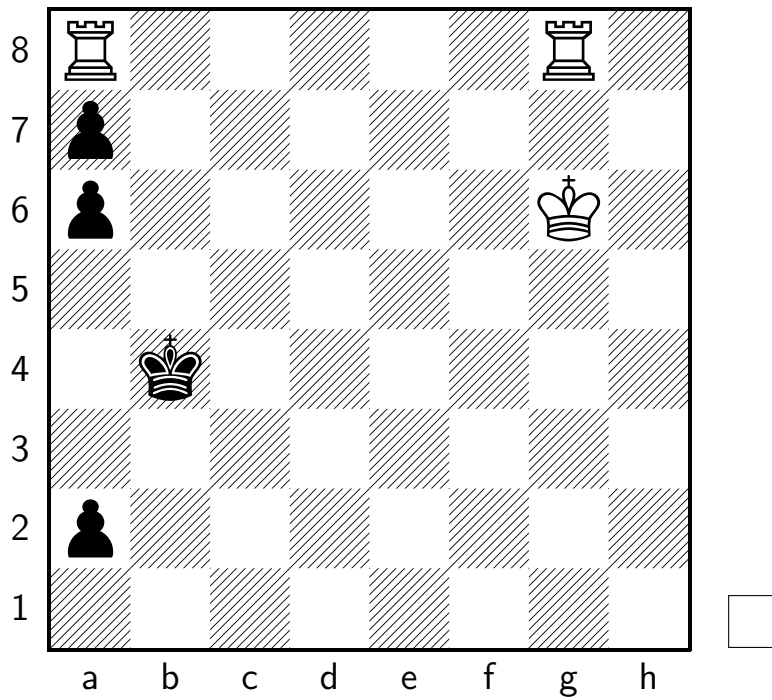


Answer:

- 1 ♖f7 ♔×f7
- 2 ♘d5+ ♔f6
- 3 ♘xa2 ♔e5
- 4 ♘b1 ♔f4
- 5 ♔d4

Source: Chessfever1

11. White play to win.

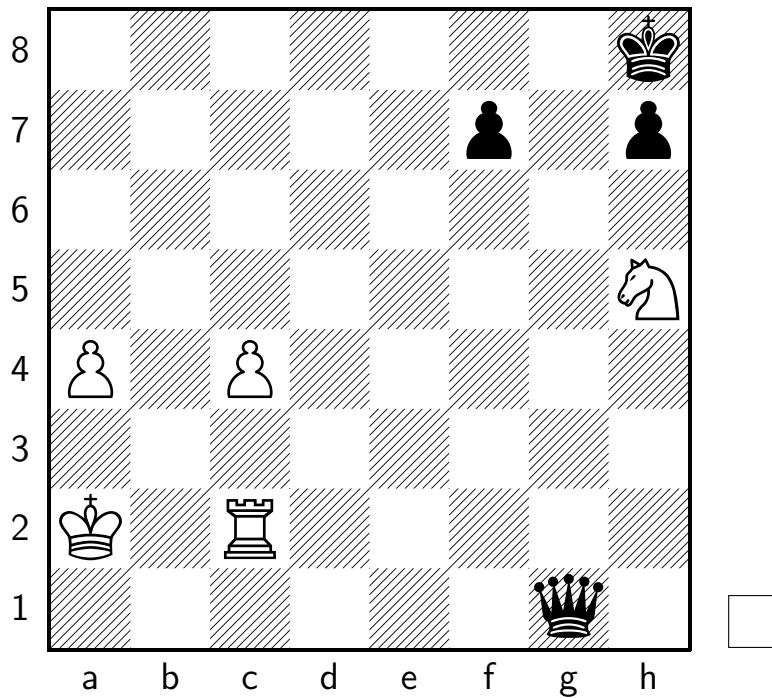


Answer:

1 ♖gb8+ ♔c3 2 ♖c8+ ♔d2 3 ♖d8+ ♔e2 4 ♖e8+ ♔f2
5 ♖e1! ♔xe1 6 ♖h8 ♔d1 7 ♖h2 a1♔ 8 ♖h1+

Source: Yehuda Hoch, L'Italia Scacchistica, 1978 (YACDB: 286661)

Q12. White play to win.



Answer:

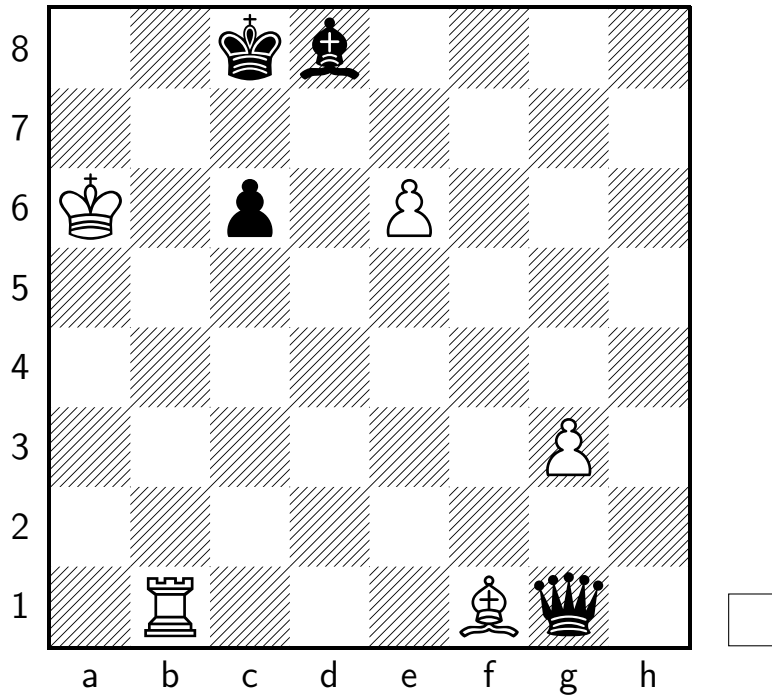
1 ♖e2 ♔g8 2 ♘g7! ♚xg7 3 ♖e8+ ♔g8 4 ♖xg8+ ♚xg8+ 5 a5

2... ♚xg7 3 ♖g2+ ♚f8 4 ♖xg8+ ♚xg8+ 5 a5

1... h6 2 ♖e8+ ♚h7 3 ♘f6+ ♚g7 4 ♖g8+

Source: Dawid Przepiórka, Szachista Polski, 1920 (YACPDB: 288576)

13. White play to win.



Answer:

1 e7 ♔×g3

2 ♖b8+ ♔×b8+

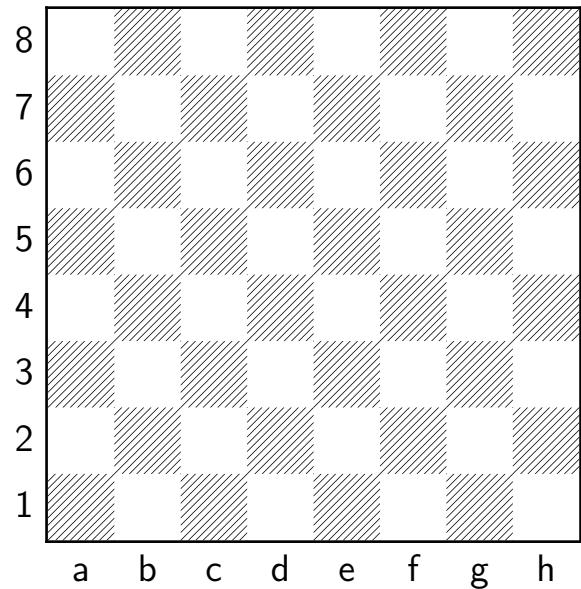
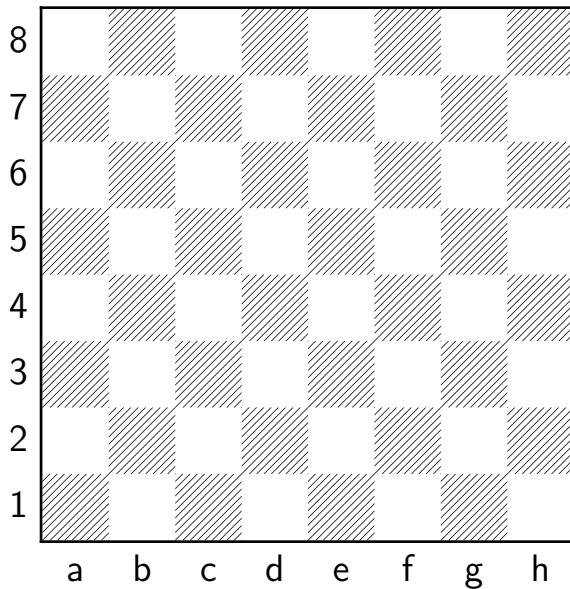
3 ♙h3+ ♕c7

4 e8 ♘#

Source: Slepian, Achalgazrda komunisti, 1983 (Modified) (YACPDB: 275122)

Q14. 8 Queens Independent puzzle. Place 8 queens on the board so that all 8 Queens don't attack each other. (8 marks)

Do you know? There are 4,426,165,368 ($_{64}C_8$) patterns to place 8 queens on the board. Among those pattern, only 92 patterns are correct. In one episode of "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took 8 minutes 20 seconds to complete this task. Can you beat him?

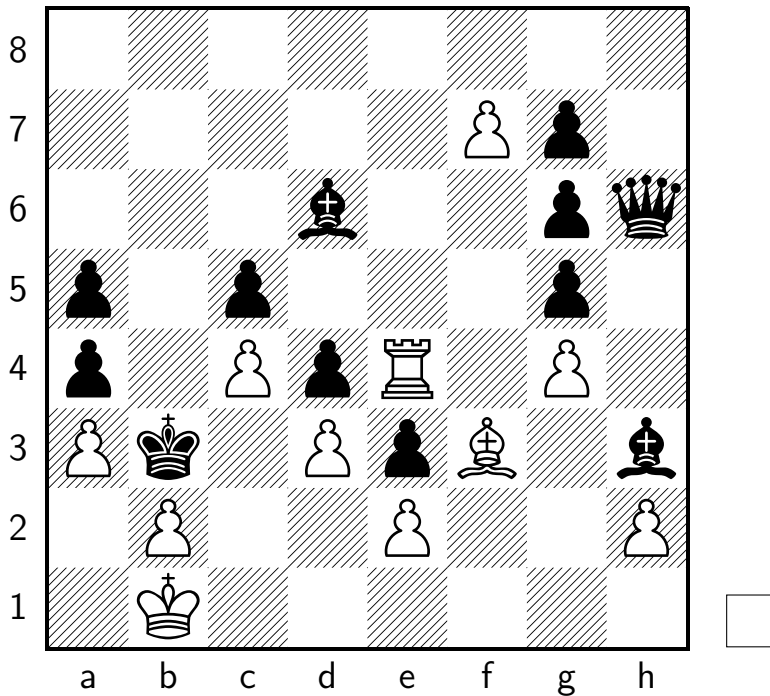


Answer:

We can not give you 8 queens, so use 8 pawns instead. Fill 8 squares in the left board with the letters "Q". When you make mistakes in the left board, write a large cross on the left board and use the right board.

Q15. Mate in six. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master, and is a famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



Answer:

- 1 ♖e7! ♗xe7
- 2 ♕f8 ♗xf8
- 3 ♗c6 ♕h4
- 4 ♗xa4+ ♔xa4
- 5 ♔a2 ♕e1
- 6 b3#

Source: "Grandmaster Solves Grandmaster-Level Puzzles" from Daniel Naroditsky's YouTube channel. The puzzle itself is puzzle ID925 of Chess.com (rating 3020 at the time).